

COMPLAINT NO. 2023-00012

IN THE MATTER OF

WILLIAM KARL ELKINS

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BEFORE THE TEXAS BEHAVIORAL
HEALTH EXECUTIVE COUNCIL

THE TEXAS STATE BOARD
OF EXAMINERS OF
PROFESSIONAL COUNSELORS

AGREED ORDER

Pursuant to its authority under §507.305 of the Texas Occupations Code, §2001.056 of the Government Code, and 22 Texas Administrative Code §884.12(e), the Executive Director for the Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council ("Council") hereby approves, ratifies, and enters this Agreed Order with the following Findings of Fact, Conclusions of Law, and Order of Council, which have been approved and accepted by **WILLIAM KARL ELKINS** ("Respondent") and which constitutes a full settlement and compromise of the complaint(s) currently pending against Respondent before the Council in the above-referenced and numbered matter(s).

FINDINGS OF FACT

1. Respondent is licensed as a Licensed Professional Counselor (#12817) in the State of Texas and are therefore subject to the jurisdiction of the Council under the Act and Rules.
2. Respondent failed to renew his license in August of 2020.
3. Respondent practiced professional counseling without a valid license from August 2020 to August 2022.

CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

1. Respondent voluntarily received a license from the Council and, therefore, is bound by the provisions of Chapters 503 and 507 of the Texas Occupations Code and the Rules of the Council, 22 Texas Administrative Code Parts 30 and 41.
2. Violation of the Council's Rules is unprofessional conduct and constitutes grounds for the imposition of sanctions under §§503.401, 507.301, and 507.351 of the Texas Occupations Code.

3. Based on the above Findings of Fact, the Council finds that Respondent violated Council Rules 22 TAC §882.23 pertaining to License Required to Practice, 22 TAC §882.21(c) pertaining to License Statuses, and 22 TAC §883.1(h) pertaining to Renewal of a License.

ORDER

IT IS HEREBY ORDERED, ADJUDGED, AND DECREED THAT:

1. Respondent's license is REPRIMANDED.
2. Respondent is assessed and shall pay, within thirty (30) days of the date this order is ratified, an administrative penalty in the total amount of \$2,000.00; of which \$250.00 represents administrative penalty and \$1,750.00 represents administrative costs.

WARNING

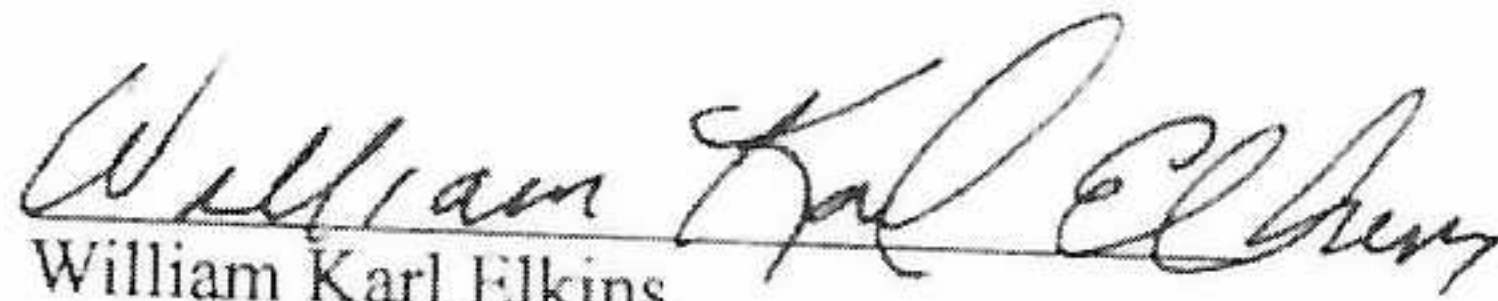
RESPONDENT'S FAILURE TO COMPLY WITH ONE OR MORE TERMS OF THIS ORDER MAY CONSTITUTE A VIOLATION OF 22 TEXAS ADMINISTRATIVE CODE §884.55 REQUIRING FURTHER DISCIPLINARY ACTION.

WAIVERS

On the underlying investigative file, Respondent has waived his or her right to an informal settlement conference, a formal hearing before an Administrative Law Judge at the State Office of Administrative Hearings (SOAH), and judicial review pursuant to Texas Government Code Chapter 2001, in exchange for the conditions set out in this Agreed Order.

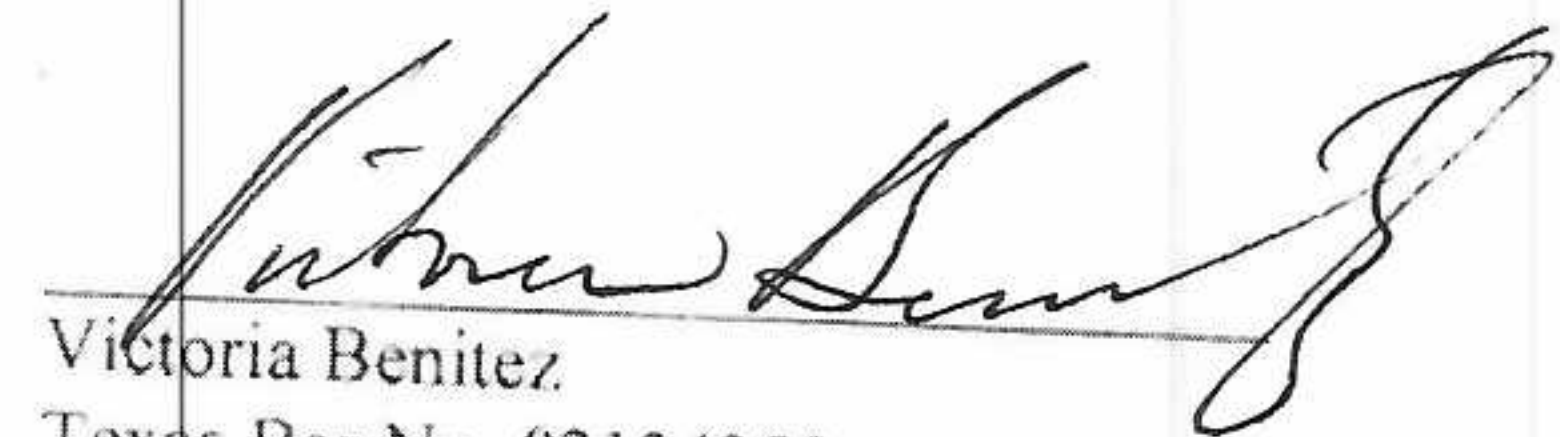
THE RESPONDENT, BY SIGNING THIS ORDER, AGREES TO ITS TERMS, ACKNOWLEDGES UNDERSTANDING OF THE FORMAL NOTICES, FINDINGS OF FACT, AND CONCLUSIONS OF LAW SET FORTH HEREIN AND COVENANTS TO SATISFACTORILY COMPLY WITH THE MANDATES OF THIS ORDER IN A TIMELY MANNER. RESPONDENT FURTHER ACKNOWLEDGES AND AGREES THAT HE OR SHE HAS AGREED TO THIS ORDER UPON THE ADVICE AND CONSENT OF COUNSEL, OR THAT HE OR SHE HAS HAD THE OPPORTUNITY TO HAVE THIS ORDER REVIEWED BY COUNSEL OF HIS OR HER CHOICE.

FOR THE RESPONDENT:


William Karl Elkins
Licensed Professional Counselor (#12817)

DATE SIGNED: 12/22/22

FOR THE STAFF OF THE COUNCIL:


Victoria Benitez
Texas Bar No. 02134350
Staff Attorney
Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council
1801 Congress, Ste. 7.300
Austin, Texas 78701

DATE SIGNED: 12-27-22

APPROVED, RATIFIED, AND ENTERED THIS 27th DAY OF December, 2022.


Darrel Spinks
Executive Director
Texas Behavioral Health Executive Council